

EXPERIMENT 4: QUALYS WHITELISTING OF IPs

1. Aim

To whitelist the Qualys scanner IP addresses on the network firewall and security devices so that vulnerability scans are not blocked, and to verify that scanning works.

2. Introduction

Qualys scans send many probe packets to target hosts. Firewalls, intrusion prevention systems (IPS) and endpoint protection may treat these as an attack and block them, which gives incomplete or failed scan results. Whitelisting means adding the Qualys scanner source IPs to an allow list so that scans reach the targets. The same applies to the Qualys platform URLs that agents and scanner appliances must reach.

3. Requirements

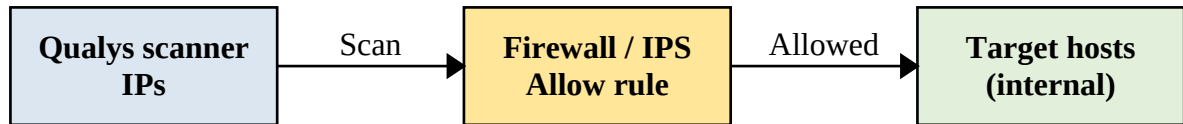
- Access to the Qualys portal to obtain the correct IP ranges for your platform
- Administrative access to the firewall / IPS / endpoint security console
- List of target IP addresses that will be scanned

4. Procedure

- Log in to Qualys and open **Help > About** (or the Qualys platform IP address documentation) to find the external scanner IP ranges and platform URLs for your subscription. Do not guess the addresses, because they depend on your platform.
- Note the IP ranges of the scanner appliance as well if an internal scanner is used.
- On the firewall, create an allow rule with source = Qualys scanner IPs, destination = target IPs and service = all ports being scanned (or any).
- On the IPS, intrusion detection and endpoint security tools, add the same source IPs to the exception or trusted list.
- Allow outbound HTTPS (443) from scanner appliances and agents to the Qualys platform URL.
- Optional: in the Qualys account security settings, restrict user logins to trusted company IP addresses if this feature is enabled for your subscription.
- Launch a test scan against a target host and review the report to confirm that it is not blocked.

5. Output

Figure 1: Network path with the whitelist rule



Source = Qualys IPs, Destination = target IPs, Action = Allow

Figure 2: Whitelisting workflow

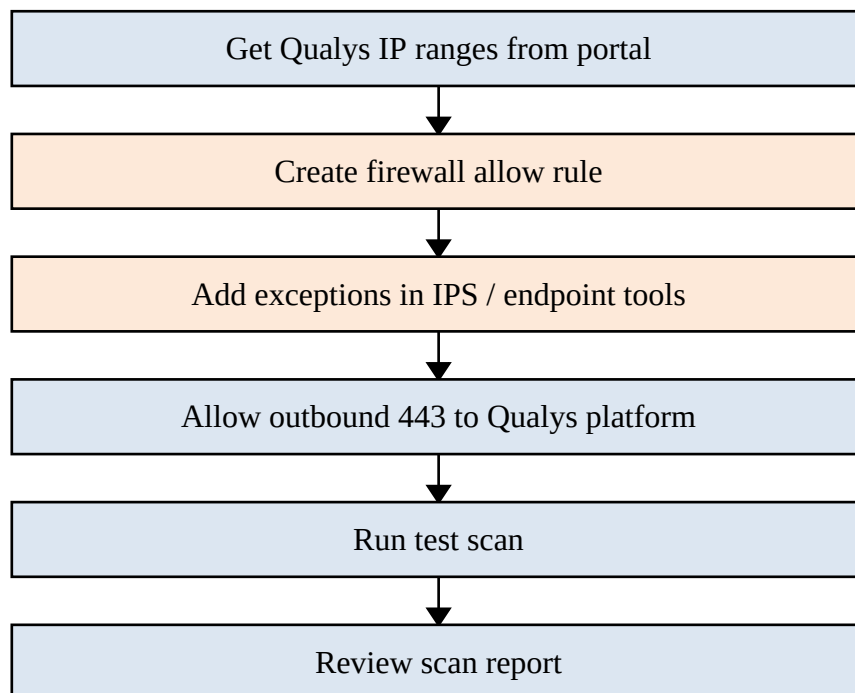
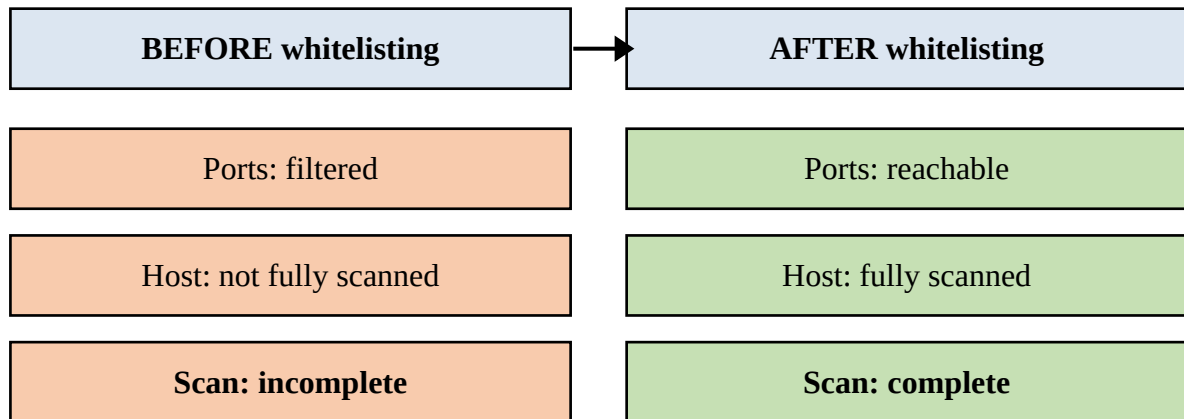


Figure 3: Scan result before and after whitelisting (illustrative)

Note: The figures show the expected structure of the output. Exact names, values and screens may differ in your own environment and software version.

6. Result

The Qualys scanner IP addresses were whitelisted on the security devices, and a test scan confirmed that the target hosts could be scanned completely.